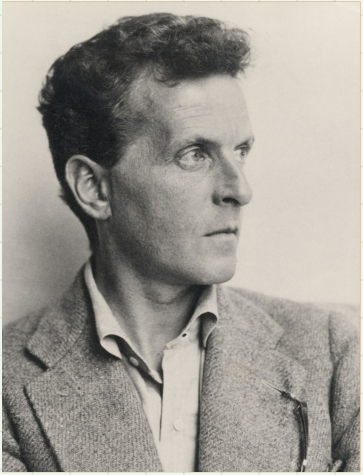


Moritz Nähr, 1930
Ludwig Wittgenstein

Ludwig Wittgenstein

1889 to 1951

Born in Vienna. He studied engineering in Berlin and Manchester, then logic with Bertrand Russell at Cambridge, where he later taught philosophy.

The pages that follow quote his *Philosophische Untersuchungen*, Philosophical Investigations, published in 1953, two years after his death, and *The Brown Book*, which he dictated in English at Cambridge in 1934 and 1935.

Subject

§ 1: a picture of language

Entry



Sandro Botticelli, about 1480
Saint Augustine in His Study

In diesen Worten erhalten wir, so scheint es mir, ein bestimmtes Bild von dem Wesen der menschlichen Sprache. Nämlich dieses: Die Wörter der Sprache benennen Gegenstände; Sätze sind Verbindungen von solchen Benennungen.

In these words we get, so it seems to me, a particular picture of the essence of human language. Namely this: the words of language name objects; sentences are combinations of such names.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophische Untersuchungen* (1953), § 1, which opens with a passage of Augustine's *Confessions* (I.8). English translation for this lecture.

§ 1: a picture of language, continued



Sandro Botticelli, about 1480
Saint Augustine in His Study

In diesem Bild von der Sprache finden wir die Wurzeln der Idee: Jedes Wort hat eine Bedeutung. Diese Bedeutung ist dem Wort zugeordnet. Sie ist der Gegenstand, für welchen das Wort steht.

In this picture of language we find the roots of the idea: every word has a meaning. This meaning is assigned to the word. It is the object for which the word stands.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophische Untersuchungen* (1953), § 1, which opens with a passage of Augustine's *Confessions* (I.8). English translation for this lecture.

Subject

§ 1: five red apples

Entry



Gerrit Dou, 1672
The Grocer's Shop

Denke nun an diese Verwendung der Sprache: Ich schicke jemand einkaufen. Ich gebe ihm einen Zettel, auf diesem stehen die Zeichen: »fünf rote Äpfel«. Er trägt den Zettel zum Kaufmann; der öffnet die Lade, auf welcher das Zeichen »Äpfel« steht; dann sucht er in einer Tabelle das Wort »rot« auf und findet ihm gegenüber ein Farbmuster;

Now think of this use of language: I send someone shopping. I give him a slip of paper, on which stand the signs: "five red apples". He carries the slip to the shopkeeper; the latter opens the drawer on which the sign "apples" stands; then he looks up the word "red" in a table and finds a colour sample opposite it;

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophische Untersuchungen* (1953), § 1. English translation for this lecture.

§ 1: five red apples, continued



Gerrit Dou, 1672
The Grocer's Shop

nun sagt er die Reihe der Grundzahlwörter (ich nehme an, er weiß sie auswendig) bis zum Worte »fünf« und bei jedem Zahlwort nimmt er einen Apfel aus der Lade, der die Farbe des Musters hat.

So, und ähnlich, operiert man mit Worten.

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now he says the series of the cardinal numerals (I assume that he knows them by heart) up to the word "five", and at each numeral he takes from the drawer an apple that has the colour of the sample.

So, and similarly, one operates with words.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophische Untersuchungen* (1953), § 1. English translation for this lecture.

Subject

The Brown Book: five apples

Entry



Johannes Vermeer, about 1658
The Little Street

[. . .] consider this language-game: A sends B to various houses in their town to fetch goods of various sorts from various people. A gives B various lists. On top of every list he puts a scribble, and B is trained to go to that house on the door of which he finds the same scribble, this is the name of the house. In the first column of every list he then finds one or more scribbles which he has been taught to read out. When he enters the house he calls out these words, and every inhabitant of the house has been trained to run up to him when a certain one of these sounds is called out, these sounds are the names of the people.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *The Brown Book*, dictated in English at Cambridge in 1934 and 1935, Part II.

Subject

The Brown Book: five apples, continued

Entry



Johannes Vermeer, about 1658
The Little Street

He then addresses himself to each one of them in turn and shews to each two consecutive scribbles which stand on the list against his name. The first of these two, people of that town have been trained to associate with some particular kind of object, say, apples. The second is one of a row of scribbles which each man carries about him on a slip of paper. The person thus addressed fetches, say, five apples. The first scribble was the generic name of the objects required, the second, the name of their number.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *The Brown Book*, dictated in English at Cambridge in 1934 and 1935, Part II.

Subject

§ 43: the word »Bedeutung«

Entry



Caravaggio, 1599 to 1600
The Calling of Saint Matthew

Man kann für eine große Klasse von Fällen der Benützung des Wortes »Bedeutung« (wenn auch nicht für alle Fälle seiner Benützung) dieses Wort so erklären: Die Bedeutung eines Wortes ist sein Gebrauch in der Sprache.

Und die Bedeutung eines Namens erklärt man manchmal dadurch, daß man auf seinen Träger zeigt.

For a large class of cases of the use of the word “meaning” (though not for all cases of its use) one can explain this word thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language.

And the meaning of a name is sometimes explained by pointing to its bearer.

Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophische Untersuchungen* (1953), § 43. English translation for this lecture.